



TRUSTS & WEALTH, PLLC

LETTER OF INTENT

Alexander James Alvarez

Written by Maria Alvarez — Mother

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How to use this letter

You are reading this because someone trusted you with the care of Alex. Maria Alvarez wrote it to hand you what a family learns over a lifetime — so you don't have to relearn it the hard way.

- ⌘ Nothing here is legally binding. This letter informs your judgment; it doesn't replace it — or any court order, care plan, or trust document.
- ⌘ If you are new to Alex, start with "A typical day" and "Communication." They will carry you through the first week.
- ⌘ In a crisis, go straight to "Medical" and "Behavioral support." There is also a separate one-page emergency sheet that pairs with this letter — keep copies where sitters, school, and the ER can grab them.
- ⌘ Check the date on the cover. Routines, medications, and contacts drift. If this letter is more than a year old, verify the medical details before relying on them.
- ⌘ No Social Security, account, or policy numbers appear in this letter, on purpose. It says where those are kept instead.
- ⌘ The ruled lines at the end of each section are for you. Write on this document — it is meant to be used, not preserved.

Thank you for caring for Alex.

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Getting started

YOUR NAME

Maria Alvarez

YOUR RELATIONSHIP TO THEM

Mother

THEIR FULL NAME

Alexander James Alvarez

WHAT THEY LIKE TO BE CALLED

Alex

TODAY'S DATE

August 7, 2026

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

About Alex

DATE OF BIRTH

March 14, 2004

DIAGNOSES AND CONDITIONS

Autism spectrum disorder; epilepsy (focal seizures); anxiety

THEIR LIFE SO FAR, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Born in Fairfax in 2004.

Diagnosed at three. Loves the Metro map.

WHAT SHOULD A STRANGER KNOW IN THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES?

Say 'Hi Alex' first. Wave, don't shake hands.

ANYTHING ELSE THAT MAKES THEM WHO THEY ARE

He remembers every birthday he's ever been told.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Family and support network

PEOPLE IN ALEX'S LIFE

Dana Alvarez

RELATIONSHIP Aunt

PHONE (703) 555-0142

EMAIL dana@example.com

THEIR ROLE Backup caregiver; knows the routines

NOTES Can be there in 15 minutes.

EMERGENCY CONTACT

Ray Alvarez

RELATIONSHIP Uncle

PHONE (703) 555-0000

WHO WOULD YOU CALL FIRST IN AN EMERGENCY?

Dana — (703) 555-0142

IS THERE ANYONE WHO SHOULD NOT BE GIVEN A ROLE?

Ray should not handle money decisions.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

A typical day

MORNING ROUTINE

Wakes 6:30. Ten minutes of radio first. Meds in the blue cup.

EVENING AND BEDTIME ROUTINE

Shower, two books, lights out 9:30.

SLEEP

Needs the hallway light on.

FOOD — FAVORITES, DISLIKES, AND RULES

Waffles cut in strips. No foods touching.

CLOTHING PREFERENCES

No tags. Soft seams only.

SENSORY SENSITIVITIES

Fire alarms are very hard. Headphones in the go-bag.

COMFORT OBJECTS AND FAVORITES

Blue train blanket — backup in the hall closet.

DESCRIBE A GOOD DAY

No surprises, program 9–2, train videos after.

DESCRIBE A HARD DAY

Starts with a schedule change. Gets quiet, then loud.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Communication

HOW THEY COMMUNICATE

Speaks in short sentences; uses an AAC app when overwhelmed.

HOW THEY SAY YES AND NO

Yes is a nod plus 'yeah'. No is walking away.

HOW THEY SHOW PAIN, OR THAT THEY FEEL SICK

Goes quiet and presses on the spot. Skipped meals mean something hurts.

HOW THEY SHOW THEY'RE BECOMING OVERWHELMED

Hums louder and rocks. That's the ten-minute warning.

WHAT TO SAY — WORDS AND APPROACHES THAT WORK

'First... then...' sentences. Real times, not 'later'.

WHAT NOT TO SAY

Never 'calm down'. Never 'maybe'.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Medical

DOCTORS AND SPECIALISTS

Dr. Sarah Kim SPECIALTY Neurology PHONE (703) 555-0199
Dr. James Okafor SPECIALTY Primary care PHONE (703) 555-0110

CURRENT MEDICATIONS

Levetiracetam DOSE AND TIMING 500 mg, morning and night WHAT IT'S FOR Seizure control
Sertraline DOSE AND TIMING 50 mg, morning WHAT IT'S FOR Anxiety

ALLERGIES AND REACTIONS

Penicillin — hives and swelling.

SEIZURE OR EMERGENCY PROTOCOL

Seizure: start timing. On his side, nothing in his mouth. Over 3 minutes: rescue med in the red pouch, call 911.

THERAPIES AND SCHEDULES

Speech Tuesdays 4pm with Ms. Kim.

EQUIPMENT THEY USE

Noise-canceling headphones; backup charger in go-bag.

INSURANCE AND MEDICAID — PLAN NAMES ONLY

Anthem HealthKeepers through Dad's employer; Virginia Medicaid — CCC Plus waiver.

PREFERRED HOSPITAL OR ER

Inova Fairfax — they have his records.

TREATMENTS THAT HAVE WORKED

Keppra stopped the drop seizures within a month.

TREATMENTS THAT DIDN'T WORK — OR MADE THINGS WORSE

Risperidone — weight gain, no benefit.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Behavioral support

KNOWN TRIGGERS

Fire alarms. Plans changing without warning. The word 'later'.

EARLY WARNING SIGNS

Louder humming, rocking, asking the same question twice.

WHAT HELPS MOST WHEN THINGS ESCALATE

Lower your voice. One person talks. Weighted blanket. Wait ten minutes.

WHAT MAKES THINGS WORSE

Touching him, crowding, raised voices, rapid questions.

IF THERE'S A FULL CRISIS, WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN — STEP BY STEP

Call Dana first, then us. REACH crisis line is on the fridge.

GUIDANCE FOR POLICE AND FIRST RESPONDERS

May not respond to commands; may run. One officer, slow voice, no restraint.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

School, work, and meaningful days

CURRENT SCHOOL OR DAY PROGRAM

Fairfax day program, 9–2 weekdays. Contact: Ms. Lopez.

SCHOOL AND IEP HISTORY — WHAT HAS WORKED

Small classes worked. Music-based learning worked. Timed tests never did.

HOW THEY LEARN BEST

Show, don't tell. One step at a time.

WORK HISTORY

Library shelving volunteer since 2023 — extremely proud of it.

JOB COACHES AND EMPLOYMENT SUPPORTS

Job coach through ServiceSource: Mr. Bell.

YOUR HOPES FOR MEANINGFUL ACTIVITY

Part-time work around trains or libraries.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Housing and daily living

CURRENT LIVING SITUATION

At home with us.

THE SUPPORT THEY NEED TO LIVE SAFELY

Needs someone present overnight; manages hygiene with prompts.

WAIVER AND WAITLIST STATUS

On the DD waiver waitlist since 2021, priority 2. Dana has the paperwork.

YOUR HOPES FOR THEIR FUTURE HOME

A small group home near his sister, with his own room.

WHAT KIND OF LIVING SITUATION WOULD YOU NOT WANT FOR THEM?

Never a large institution. Never far from his sister.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Benefits and finances

On purpose, this letter contains no Social Security, account, or policy numbers. The last entry in this section says where the family keeps them.

BENEFITS THEY RECEIVE TODAY

SSI since 18. Virginia Medicaid.

REPRESENTATIVE PAYEE

Mother is representative payee.

ABLE ACCOUNT

ABLE account managed by Mother.

EXISTING TRUSTS AND WHO RUNS THEM

Special needs trust (2022). Trustee: Dana Alvarez. Drafted by Trusts & Wealth.

ANYTHING PENDING

Waiver slot appeal pending — Dana is handling it.

WHERE THE OFFICIAL NUMBERS AND PAPERS LIVE

Gray fireproof box, bedroom closet. Key taped in the kitchen junk drawer.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Friends, joy, and faith

FRIENDSHIPS TO PROTECT

Marcus from program — pizza Fridays.

ACTIVITIES AND HOBBIES

Trainspotting at the Vienna platform, Saturdays.

FAITH COMMUNITY AND PRACTICES

St. Mark's — Deacon Reyes knows him well.

HOLIDAYS AND FAMILY TRADITIONS

Christmas Eve: pajamas, one gift, Muppet Christmas Carol (the DVD).

TRAVEL

Window seat, direct flights only.

WHAT BRINGS THEM JOY

Trains. Always trains.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Legal and advocacy

DECISION-MAKING STATUS

Supported decision-making agreement (2023); healthcare POA held by Mother.

CASE MANAGERS AND ADVOCATES

Support coordinator: Ms. Green, Fairfax CSB.

ATTORNEY

Claire Kelly, Trusts & Wealth — trust and POA work.

WHAT YOU'VE HAD TO FIGHT FOR — AND HOW YOU WON

Won the 2021 waiver appeal with the neurologist's letter.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Guidance for the trustee

WHEN YOU PICTURE THE TRUST DOING ITS JOB, WHAT IS IT PAYING FOR?

A life, not a ledger. Concert aides, the good mattress, direct flights.

WHAT SHOULD BE AN EASY YES?

Anything for the train hobby under \$200. Respite for caregivers.

SPENDING NOW VERSUS PRESERVING FOR LATER

Spend for quality of life now; the house covers the far future.

WHAT DESERVES EXTRA SCRUTINY?

Any request routed through Ray.

WHEN ALEX'S WISHES AND THEIR SAFETY DISAGREE

Risks that bruise, yes. Risks that break, no.

WHO SHOULD THE TRUSTEE TALK WITH BEFORE BIG DECISIONS?

Dana, then his sister. Dr. Kim for anything medical.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Final wishes

FUNERAL OR MEMORIAL PREFERENCES

Small, at St. Mark's. His playlist, not hymns.

BURIAL OR CREMATION

Cremation. Ashes with ours eventually.

RELIGIOUS OBSERVANCES

Catholic rites.

ORGAN DONATION

Yes — recorded at the DMV.

END-OF-LIFE CARE WISHES

Comfort first. Advance directive in the fireproof box.

WHERE THE PAPERS ARE

All of it in the gray fireproof box.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

A personal message

TO ALEX'S FUTURE CAREGIVERS

When he is difficult, he is scared. Thank you for being with him.

TO THEIR SIBLINGS

Sofia — he is not your burden. Your own life matters too.

TO ALEX

Alex: you are the best thing we ever did.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS
